

X-FACTOR

Mutant investigators

A number of teams have used the name X-Factor. The first was comprised of the original X-MEN, who had left PROFESSOR X's team over the fact that he'd installed their old foe MAGNETO as the team's new leader. Posing as mutant hunters, ARCHANGEL, BEAST, CYCLOPS, JEAN GREY, and ICEMAN set up shop in Manhattan. They pretended to set out to bring mutants in to justice, but instead trained them in the use of their powers and in how to blend into regular society. Their recruits included ARTIE, BOOM BOOM, RUSTY COLLINS, LEECH, RICTOR, and SKIDS.



Madrox is the heart of the latest X-Factor.

UNDERCOVER HUNTERS

When in costume, X-Factor pretended to be the outlaw X-Terminators. Eventually, though, they gave up on this ruse, believing it to cause more harm than good. The original members opted to rejoin the X-Men instead of continuing on. Rather than let X-Factor fade away, the US government formed a new team using the name. This started out with HAVOK, JAMIE MADROX, POLARIS, QUICKSILVER,

STRONG GUY, and WOLFSBANE, with VALERIE COOPER as their governmental liaison. A later version of the team included the criminals MYSTIQUE, SABRETOOTH, SHARD, and WILD CHILD led by FORGE.



X-FACTOR I

- 1 Archangel
- 2 Iceman
- 3 Cyclops
- 4 Jean Grey
- 5 Beast

X-FACTOR III

- 1 Strong Guy
- 2 Rictor
- 3 Wolfsbane
- 4 Madrox
- 5 Siryn
- 6 M

FACTFILE

NOTABLE MEMBERS

MADROX

Creates duplicates of himself.

STRONG GUY

Transforms kinetic energy directed against himself into strength.

SIRYN

Vocal chords can create sonic blasts.

M

Super-strength, durability and flight.

RICTOR

Currently powerless; formerly could create seismic shifts in the Earth.

BUTTERFLY

Instinctively understands causality, and creates a desired effect through a small action.

WOLFSBANE

Can transform into a wolflike creature.

BASE

Mutant Town, New York City

FIRST APPEARANCE

X-Factor #1 (June 2002)



ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• X-Factor #6

The first regular appearance of Apocalypse.

• X-Factor #149

X-Factor disbands, and Havok is sent to Earth-1298.

X-Factor Vol. 2 #1

In the wake of M-Day, Jamie Madrox forms X-Factor Investigations.

A third version of this team reunited many members of the various government teams. However, it broke up after an exploding time machine sent Havok to Earth-1298, in which many of roles of the mainstream Earth's heroes and villains were swapped. Later a governmental Mutant Civil Rights Task Force used the X-Factor name for a short while.

After M-DAY, Jamie Madrox opened up a private investigations firm called X-Factor Investigations with many of his old friends. This included M, Layla Miller (Butterfly), SIRYN, Strong Guy, Wolfsbane, and a powerless RICTOR. The team set out to determine what happened on M-Day and became embroiled in the hunt for the first mutant baby born after that fateful event. Recently, Madrox and Miller traveled to the future of Earth-1191, in which the birth of the mutant baby led to mutants being rounded up into concentration camps. M, Madrox, Siryn, and Strong Guy are all that remain of the original team. **MF**



Despite its low profile, X-Factor Investigations still deals with larger threats—like Sentinels.